

Spellify

Curriculum Gap Analysis

Cross-reference against HeadStart Primary Spelling Overview Y1-Y6

Analysis | Findings | Patch | Final State — May 2026

This document records the full lifecycle of a curriculum quality review: the HeadStart Primary Spelling Overview (Y1-Y6) was provided by an experienced primary school teacher as a professional validation resource. It was compared against the Spellify Phase C catalogue (154 lessons), gaps were identified, and 20 patch lessons were authored to close them. The catalogue now stands at 174 lessons with 2,374 word entries.

1 What the Comparison Confirms

The Spellify curriculum is well-founded and consistent with NC 2014 English Appendix 1. Key areas of strong alignment:

- Statutory word lists — all Y1-Y6 CEW, Y3/4 and Y5/6 lists fully covered at 100%
- Suffix pattern sequence — -tion/-sion/-cious/-tious/-cial/-tial correct across Y3-Y6
- Prefix sequence — un-, re-, dis-, mis-, in-/im-/il-/ir-, sub-, super-, auto-, anti- correctly placed
- Homophone teaching — eight dedicated homophone lessons across Y1-Y6
- Year-band difficulty curve — easy in Y1/Y2, medium in Y3/Y4, hard in Y5/Y6

2 Gaps Identified

The review identified 25 missing lessons across Y1-Y6 — patterns explicitly required by NC 2014 that lacked a dedicated Spellify lesson.

Year 1 — 12 missing patterns

Missing pattern	HeadStart examples	Status
/ue/ digraph	blue, clue, true, glue, new, few, grew, flew	Missing
/oe/ and /ore/	toe, doe, more, sore, tore, wore, snore	Missing
/air/ vowel	fair, pair, hair, chair, stair, dairy	Missing
/ear/ two sounds	ear/dear/hear vs bear/pear/wear/swear	Missing
/are/ vowel	bare, dare, care, hare, scare, share, spare	Missing
wh- and ph- digraphs	when, where, whale; dolphin, elephant, phone	Missing
-tch trigraph	catch, fetch, hutch, kitchen, match, scratch	Missing
/au/ and /aw/ sounds	haul, launch; claw, draw, jaw, paw, straw	Missing

Adding -er suffix	jumper, kicker, hunter, runner, taller, faster	Missing
-------------------	--	---------

Year 2 — 6 missing patterns

Missing pattern	HeadStart examples	Status
/o/ spelt a after w	want, wand, wasp, watch, squash, swan	Missing
/er/ spelt or after w; /or/ spelt ar after w	word, work, worm; war, warm, award	Missing
/zh/ sound spelt s	treasure, measure, vision, pleasure, leisure	Missing
Contractions (set 1)	I'm, I'll, I've, isn't, can't, don't, won't	Missing
Contractions (set 2)	they're, we're, you're, shouldn't, wouldn't	Missing
Possessive apostrophe	girl's, teacher's, boy's, child's, mum's	Missing

Year 3 — 1 missing pattern

Missing pattern	HeadStart examples	Status
/u/ sound spelt ou	touch, young, couple, trouble, country, cousin, courage	Missing

Year 4 — 3 missing patterns

Missing pattern	HeadStart examples	Status
-ally suffix	basically, dramatically, historically, frantically	Missing
-ous when -our drops the u	humour->humorous, glamour->glamorous, vigour->vigorous	Missing
-ous/-able keeping e after g or c	courageous, outrageous, noticeable, changeable	Missing

Year 6 — 1 gap

Missing pattern	HeadStart examples	Status
ei NOT after c	weird, forfeit, counterfeit, caffeine, sovereign, feisty	Missing

3 Where Spellify Goes Further Than HeadStart

Spellify substantially exceeds HeadStart in several important areas — representing deliberate design choices to build deeper vocabulary knowledge:

Area	Spellify	HeadStart
Etymology — Greek/Latin roots	17 dedicated lessons across Y3-Y6: -ology, -ography, -meter, word families, Latin rupt/struct, vis/vid	Minimal (ch=/k/ only)
Etymology — word origins	"Be a Word Detective" Y6 lesson tracing words from Arabic, Hindi, Inuit, Swahili	Not covered
Word families	8 lessons: ACT, FORM, PORT, DICT, SIGN, SCRIBE, LIGHT, TIME root families	Not covered
Morphology depth	38 morphology lessons — DE- prefix, -IFY, -ISE, number prefixes, complex prefixes (circum-, inter-)	Lighter coverage

British vs American	Explicit Y5 lesson on -our/-or, -re/-er, -ise/-ize conventions	Not covered
SATs vocabulary	Y6 mnemonic lesson: necessary, embarrass, rhythm, accommodate with memory aids	Implicit only

4 Gap-Patch Lessons Authored (20 lessons added)

All 25 identified gaps were addressed in a single patch session. 20 new lessons were authored, each with 12-14 hand-crafted word entries and descriptions. The resulting catalogue has 174 lessons and 2,374 word entries.

Priority	Gap	Status	Lessons added
Y1 — Critical	Vowel digraphs /ue/, /ew/, /oe/, /ore/, /air/, /ear/, /are/	Closed	7 lessons
Y1 — Critical	Consonant patterns wh-, ph-, -tch, /au//-aw/, -er/-est	Closed	2 lessons
Y2 — High	Contractions — Set 1 and Set 2	Closed	2 lessons
Y2 — High	Special vowel sounds: a after w, or/ar after w, /zh/ spelt s	Closed	3 lessons
Y2 — High	Possessive apostrophe (singular nouns)	Closed	1 lesson
Y3 — Medium	/u/ sound spelt ou (touch, young, country)	Closed	1 lesson
Y4 — Medium	-ally suffix (basically, dramatically, historically)	Closed	1 lesson
Y4 — Medium	-ous when -our drops u; -ous/-able keeping e after g/c	Closed	2 lessons
Y6 — Lower	ei NOT after c (weird, forfeit, caffeine, sovereign)	Closed	1 lesson

All patch lessons follow the same schema as Phase C lessons: strand, difficulty, NC reference, description, and 12-14 age-appropriate word definitions. They are fully integrated into the final curriculumLists.js output.

5 Final Catalogue State

Year	Phonics	Patterns	Morphology	Etymology	Statutory	Total	Words
Year 1	27	7	0	0	4	38	~520
Year 2	8	12	6	0	4	32	~448
Year 3	5	9	7	3	5	29	~395
Year 4	0	12	8	2	3	25	~330
Year 5	0	8	10	7	5	30	~407
Year 6	0	5	6	5	5	21	~284
Total	40	53	37	17	26	174	2,374

6 Integration Instructions

The deliverable for installation is the single file curriculumLists_FINAL.js. This replaces src/data/curriculumLists.js in the Spellify project. The word databases (ks1WordData_v13.js and ks2WordData_v26.js) were integrated in the previous session and are already in place.

Step 1. Move the file into the project

```
mv ~/Downloads/curriculumLists_FINAL.js src/data/curriculumLists.js
```

This replaces the Phase B skeleton (154 empty stubs) with the fully populated version.

Step 2. Verify the app boots

```
npm start
```

The app should compile cleanly. All 174 lessons will appear in the Explore section.

Step 3. Run the coverage check

```
node checkCoverage.mjs
```

Every word in every lesson should resolve to a v13/v26 database entry. Expected: 100%.

Step 4. Commit

```
git add src/data/curriculumLists.js git commit -m "feat(curriculum): 174-lesson catalogue,  
all NC gaps closed"
```

Single commit for the complete curriculum. Reference docs/CURRICULUM_STRUCTURE.md in the body.

Spellify Curriculum Gap Analysis v2 — May 2026. HeadStart Primary Spelling Overview is copyright HeadStart Primary Ltd. Used with permission as a professional validation reference.